SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #6 · WEALTH AND PRIVILEGE

“I earned everything; others just didn't try.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

A family that prized hard work, a career that rewarded effort, or a community that looked down on struggle can teach us that success is simply the result of trying. Because effort really does matter, the belief feels true. What it leaves out is the help, health, timing, opportunity, and gifts that came from outside us, and the hardships other people carry that we cannot see.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture honors diligence. Proverbs says diligent hands bring profit. But Scripture also says that every good gift comes from God, and Moses warned Israel not to say, “The power and strength of my hands have made this wealth for me,” because it is the Lord who gives the power to gain wealth. Paul asks, “What do you have that you did not receive?” These passages do not tell us to feel guilty for working hard or for having something. They invite thankfulness, humility, and open hands toward those who have less.

> *“You might say in your heart, ‘The power and strength of my hands have made this wealth for me.’ But remember that it is the LORD your God who gives you the power to gain wealth, in order to confirm His covenant that He swore to your fathers even to this day”* (Deuteronomy 8:17–18).

Also see

> “For who makes you so superior? What do you have that you did not receive? And if you did receive it, why do you boast as though you did not?” (1 Corinthians 4:7).

> “Every good and perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father of the heavenly lights, with whom there is no change or shifting shadow” (James 1:17).

> “The rich and the poor have this in common: The LORD is Maker of them all” (Proverbs 22:2).

> “The earth is the LORD’s, and the fullness thereof, the world and all who dwell therein” (Psalm 24:1).

Common self-statements

- Anyone who really tried would have what I have.
- People who struggle brought it on themselves.
- I did this on my own.
- I do not owe anyone anything.
- If they wanted it, they would have worked harder.
- Being generous would only reward laziness.

Common logical errors

- Fundamental attribution error: Crediting my results to effort alone and other people’s results to their flaws.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that people either earn what they have or deserve what they lack.
- Mental filter: Remembering my effort and overlooking the help, health, and opportunities I received.
- Overgeneralizing: Judging everyone who struggles by what I assume about a few.

Challenging questions

- What help, timing, health, or opportunity did I receive that I did not earn?
- Who taught me, hired me, or gave me a chance?
- What hidden burdens could someone else be carrying that I cannot see?
- What do I have that I did not receive?
- How would my view of others change if I held success more loosely?
- What is one way I can use what I have to bless someone else?

Truth summary

> Effort matters, and I can be glad about work well done. But everything I have, including my health, my abilities, and my opportunities, came through God's hand and the help of others. I can be thankful instead of proud, and generous instead of judging.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Humility
- Pride
- Thankful
- Giving
- Riches, True

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Pride
- Money/Riches

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Good Good Father — Chris Tomlin
God's fatherly love is deeper than human approval or achievement.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Forever — Kari Jobe
Christ's resurrection grounds hope in His victory over sin and death.

To God Be the Glory — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn celebrates redemption and forgiveness through Christ.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I earned everything; others just didn't try"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I earned everything; others just didn't try." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did I receive that I did not earn?
- ☐ Who helped me along the way?
- ☐ What might this person be carrying that I cannot see?
- ☐ What would thankfulness look like today?
- ☐ How can I use what I have to help someone?
- ☐ Where has pride shaped how I see others?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Hard work matters, and so does grace.
- ☐ Everything I have is a gift to be stewarded.
- ☐ I do not know what others carry.
- ☐ Thankfulness makes me more generous.
- ☐ God, not my effort, gives the power to get wealth.
- ☐ I can honor my work and still stay humble.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Deuteronomy 8:17–18**
  "You might say in your heart, 'The power and strength of my hands have made this wealth for me.' But remember that it is the LORD your God who gives you the power to gain wealth, in order to confirm His covenant that He swore to your fathers even to this day."
- ☐ **1 Corinthians 4:7**
  "For who makes you so superior? What do you have that you did not receive? And if you did receive it, why do you boast as though you did not?"
- ☐ **James 1:17**
  "Every good and perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father of the heavenly lights, with whom there is no change or shifting shadow."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ What I received: Each evening, write one thing today that came from someone else's help or from God's provision, and one thing you did yourself.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Deuteronomy 8:18 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God gives me the power to work, so I can be thankful, humble, and generous.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Humility" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ List five gifts you did not earn. Include people who helped you, abilities you were born with, and opportunities that came your way.
- ☐ Thank someone who helped you. Write or say a specific thank-you to one person who made a difference in your path.
- ☐ Ask a question instead of making a judgment. Next time you assume someone "just didn't try," ask a kind question about their story and listen.
- ☐ Give one planned gift. Choose an amount you are comfortable with and give it to someone in need, quietly.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I earned everything; others just didn't try": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A gift I received
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I earned everything; others just didn't try.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, every good gift comes from You. Forgive me for the pride that says I did it all myself. Make me thankful, humble, and generous toward people who carry burdens I cannot see. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #7 · WEALTH AND PRIVILEGE

"My worth depends on staying wealthy."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When a family, a profession, or a social circle measures people by what they own, we can learn that value equals net worth. A parent's approval may have followed achievement, or a past loss may have made money feel like the only protection against shame. Over time the account balance can become a report card on the person.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, "Watch out! Guard yourselves against every form of greed, for one's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions." Scripture says we are fearfully and wonderfully made, and Paul tells the rich not to be conceited or to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy. Worth is a gift from our Creator, not a number we maintain. It cannot be raised by gain or lowered by loss.

> *"And He said to them, 'Watch out! Guard yourselves against every form of greed, for one's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions.'"* (Luke 12:15).

Also see

> "Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy. Instruct them to do good, to be rich in good works, and to be generous and ready to share, treasuring up for themselves a firm foundation for the future, so that they may take hold of that which is truly life" (1 Timothy 6:17–19).

> "He who trusts in his riches will fall, but the righteous will thrive like foliage" (Proverbs 11:28).

> "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:14).

> "What does it profit a man to gain the whole world, yet forfeit his soul?" (Mark 8:36).

Common self-statements

- If I lost my money, I would be nothing.
- I am only as valuable as my portfolio.
- People respect me because of what I have.
- I cannot stop earning or I will fall apart.
- Without wealth I would have no identity.
- Rest is for people who have not made it.

Common logical errors

- Emotional reasoning: Feeling secure when the numbers are high and worthless when they drop.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing myself as either successful or a failure.
- Labeling: Calling myself a "winner" or "loser" based on money.
- Fortune telling: Assuming that losing wealth would mean losing everyone's respect.

Challenging questions

- What did I learn about worth growing up, and from whom?

- If my finances changed tomorrow, what about me would remain?
- What does God say my worth is based on?
- Who loves me whether or not I have money?
- What do I do to keep my balance high that is costing me peace?
- What would it look like to receive my value as a gift?

Truth summary

> My worth was settled by God when He made me and by Christ when He died for me. It does not rise with my income or fall with my losses. I can steward wealth well and enjoy it, but I do not need it to prove that I matter.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Money
- Worldly
- Riches, Beware of
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Money/Riches
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Hello My Name Is — Matthew West
God's redeemed-child identity challenges labels of regret and defeat.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "My worth depends on staying wealthy"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My worth depends on staying wealthy." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn that wealth equals worth?
- ☐ What would remain if my money were gone?
- ☐ What does God say about my value?
- ☐ Who loves me apart from my money?
- ☐ What am I doing to protect my balance that costs me peace?
- ☐ What is one way to rest in my worth today?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am valuable because God made me.
- ☐ My worth does not go up or down with my balance.
- ☐ I can enjoy wealth without needing it.
- ☐ My hope is in God, not in money.
- ☐ I can rest without losing my value.
- ☐ Christ's love is the one thing that cannot be lost.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Luke 12:15**
  "And He said to them, 'Watch out! Guard yourselves against every form of greed, for one's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions.'"
- ☐ **1 Timothy 6:17–19**
  "Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy. Instruct them to do good, to be rich in good works, and to be generous and ready to share, treasuring up for themselves a firm foundation for the future, so that they may take hold of that which is truly life."
- ☐ **Psalm 139:14**
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Worth check: Each day, write one thing that has value in you that has nothing to do with money, and note your peace from 0 to 10.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Luke 12:15 becomes: "Sarah can write: "My life is more than my possessions, and I am valued by God.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Riches, Beware of" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ Write "not for sale" qualities. List five things that are true of you that money cannot buy or take away.
- ☐ Take a planned break. Spend a half day away from checking accounts or earnings and notice how it feels.
- ☐ Tell a trusted person. Share where you have been tying your worth to money and ask for their view.
- ☐ Read the verse aloud. Say Luke 12:15 or Psalm 139:14 each morning for a week.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My worth depends on staying wealthy": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Worth received
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My worth depends on staying wealthy.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You made me and You know me. Free me from measuring myself by what I own. Help me hold wealth with open hands and rest in the worth You have already given me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #8 · WEALTH AND PRIVILEGE

"People only like me for my money."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Being asked for loans, gifts, or favors, watching friends change after a promotion or inheritance, or seeing someone use a relationship for gain can make it hard to trust anyone. Family conflict over money can also teach us that affection comes with strings. Some suspicion is wise, but when it turns into a rule that applies to everyone, it can leave a person lonely in a crowd.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is realistic that a crowd of companions can lead to ruin. It also says that a friend loves at all times and that there is a friend who stays closer than a brother. Samuel was told that people look at outward things, but the Lord looks at the heart. Jesus called His followers friends and laid down His life for them. These passages do not ask us to be naive. They invite us to look for love that is tested over time, to be a true friend ourselves, and to trust the One who loves us for who we are.

> *"A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity"* (Proverbs 17:17).

Also see

> "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'" (1 Samuel 16:7).

> "A man of many companions may come to ruin, but there is a friend who stays closer than a brother" (Proverbs 18:24).

> "Greater love has no one than this, that he lay down his life for his friends" (John 15:13).

> "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!" (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

Common self-statements

- If I had less, no one would be around.
- Everyone wants something from me.
- I cannot tell who is sincere.
- I am safer keeping people at a distance.
- Nobody would choose me for me.
- Being generous only attracts users.

Common logical errors

- Mind reading: Assuming I know that others are only after my money.
- Overgeneralizing: Turning a few painful experiences into a rule about everyone.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling suspicious and therefore concluding that I am being used.
- Discounting the positive: Dismissing real kindness as a trick.

Challenging questions

- Which relationships have lasted through hard times, whether or not money was involved?

- What specific evidence do I have about each person's motives?
- Have I ever been valued for something other than money?
- What are the signs of a friend who is true?
- How could I test trust slowly and wisely?
- Am I treating good people as if they were the ones who hurt me?

Truth summary

> Some people have used me, and wisdom is not the same as fear. But not everyone is the same. God loves me for who I am, and there are people who love me for who I am too. I can use wise limits and still take small steps toward real friendship.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Friendship
- Love, For Others
- Trust
- Money
- Loneliness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Money/Riches

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

Love Take Me Over — Steven Curtis Chapman
Receiving God's love can shape loving action instead of fear or performance.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus — Keith and Kristyn Getty
This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People only like me for my money"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People only like me for my money." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who has stayed with me through hard times?
- ☐ What evidence do I have about this person's motives?
- ☐ What boundary would help me feel safe?
- ☐ What is one small step toward trust?
- ☐ How can I be a true friend?
- ☐ Where has old hurt shaped how I see people now?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am loved by God for who I am.
- ☐ Not everyone has an agenda.
- ☐ Wise boundaries are good; walls are not.
- ☐ True friends show up over time.
- ☐ I can be a true friend myself.
- ☐ I can take small steps toward trust.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Proverbs 17:17
  "A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity."
- ☐ 1 Samuel 16:7
  "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'"
- ☐ John 15:13
  "Greater love has no one than this, that he lay down his life for his friends."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Who showed up: Each week, write the name of one person who has been kind without any link to money and what they did.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 17:17 becomes: "Sarah can write: "A friend loves at all times, and I can look for and become that kind of friend.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Friendship" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ List people who have been faithful. Write down the names of people who stayed in hard seasons and what they did.
- ☐ Set one wise boundary. Decide ahead what you will and will not give, so you can be generous without resentment.
- ☐ Take one small step toward a friend. Invite someone for coffee or a walk with no agenda and notice how it goes.
- ☐ Be the friend. Do one kind thing this week for someone without telling anyone.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People only like me for my money": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A true friend moment
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People only like me for my money.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You love me for who I am. Heal the places where I have been used. Give me wisdom to set good boundaries, courage to trust slowly, and the joy of being a true friend. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #9 · WEALTH AND PRIVILEGE

"I must never let anyone see me struggle."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

In families, workplaces, and communities where success is a sign of status, struggle can feel like exposure. A parent who always looked fine, a culture of "keeping up appearances," or a past experience when vulnerability was used against us can teach us to hide. The cost is quiet: stress, secrecy, and loneliness among people who think everything is fine.

What Scripture teaches

Paul wrote that Christ told him, "My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness." We are told to bear one another's burdens, to confess to one another and pray for one another, and to approach the throne of grace with confidence to find help in time of need. God never asked us to look strong. He invites us to bring our weakness to Him and to safe people, because help flows toward honesty.

> *"But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me"* (2 Corinthians 12:9).

Also see

> "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ" (Galatians 6:2).

> "Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed. The prayer of a righteous man has great power to prevail" (James 5:16).

> "Cast your burden upon the LORD and He will sustain you; He will never let the righteous be shaken" (Psalm 55:22).

> "Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need" (Hebrews 4:16).

Common self-statements

- If they knew I was struggling, they would lose respect for me.
- I have to look like I have it all together.
- Needing help means I have failed.
- Struggle is for other people.
- I cannot afford to be seen as weak.
- I will handle it alone.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that others will judge me if they see my struggle.
- Should statements: Insisting that I must always appear strong.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing myself as either fine or a failure.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know what others would think of my struggle.

Challenging questions

- What have I been hiding, and what has hiding cost me?
- Who has been honest with me about their struggles, and what did I think of them?
- What do I believe would happen if one safe person knew?
- What does God say about weakness?
- Where did I learn that struggle must be hidden?
- Who is one safe person I could tell?

Truth summary

> Everyone struggles, and hiding it does not make me stronger. God's grace meets me in my weakness, and He gives me people to help carry what I cannot carry alone. I can choose a safe person and let myself be known.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Weakness
- Help
- Hardship
- Troubles
- Confession

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Trouble/Hardship

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Broken Things — Matthew West
God can work through imperfect people without waiting for them to become flawless.

Worn — Tenth Avenue North
Weariness can be expressed honestly while asking God for restoration.

Softly and Tenderly — Kristyn Getty with Vince Gill, Ellie Holcomb and Sierra Hull
This older hymn pictures Christ's gracious invitation to return rather than hide in shame.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I must never let anyone see me struggle"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I must never let anyone see me struggle." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What have I been hiding?
- ☐ What has hiding cost me?
- ☐ Who is a safe person I could tell?
- ☐ What does God say about weakness?
- ☐ What is one honest step I can take?
- ☐ Where did I learn to hide struggle?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I do not have to look strong to be loved.
- ☐ God's power shows up in my weakness.
- ☐ Asking for help is wise, not weak.
- ☐ Everyone struggles in some way.
- ☐ Safe people can carry part of my load.
- ☐ I can let myself be known.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **2 Corinthians 12:9**
  "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."
- ☐ **Galatians 6:2**
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ **Hebrews 4:16**
  "Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What I let someone see: Each week, note one honest thing you shared with a safe person, and what happened afterward.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 2 Corinthians 12:9 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God's grace is enough for me, even when I am weak, so I can let a safe person help.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Weakness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Name one safe person. Choose someone who is trustworthy, discreet, and kind.
- [ ] Share one real struggle. Tell that person one honest thing and notice how they respond.
- [ ] Pray with honesty. Tell God exactly where you are struggling, without polish.
- [ ] Reach out for practical help. If the struggle involves money, health, or family, contact a counselor, advisor, or pastor this week.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I must never let anyone see me struggle": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	An honest moment
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I must never let anyone see me struggle.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You see my struggle and You are not ashamed of me. Give me courage to be honest with You and with safe people. Let Your power be made perfect in my weakness. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #10 · WEALTH AND PRIVILEGE

“Money can fix any problem.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When money has solved real problems, such as a repair, a medical bill, or a hard season, it is easy to conclude that it can solve everything. Families who handle conflict by paying for it, or who show love with gifts, can pass this lesson on. The belief holds until a problem comes along that money cannot touch, such as grief, a broken trust, loneliness, or a wandering heart.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture teaches that money is useful but limited. “He who loves money is never satisfied by money.” “Riches are worthless in the day of wrath, but righteousness brings deliverance from death.” Jesus asked, “What does it profit a man to gain the whole world, yet forfeit his soul?” Paul learned to be content in every situation, because his strength came from Christ. God gives wealth for good use, but the deepest problems need what money cannot buy: forgiveness, love, presence, and truth.

> *“He who loves money is never satisfied by money, and he who loves wealth is never satisfied by income. This too is futile”* (Ecclesiastes 5:10).

Also see

> “Riches are worthless in the day of wrath, but righteousness brings deliverance from death” (Proverbs 11:4).

> “Some trust in chariots and others in horses, but we trust in the name of the LORD our God” (Psalm 20:7).

> “I know how to live humbly, and I know how to abound. I am accustomed to any and every situation—to being filled and being hungry, to having plenty and having need. I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength” (Philippians 4:12–13).

> “What does it profit a man to gain the whole world, yet forfeit his soul?” (Mark 8:36).

Common self-statements

- If I just had enough money, this would be solved.
- I can pay my way out of anything.
- Problems are only a matter of resources.
- Giving gifts shows people I care.
- Money is the answer to every worry.
- If it cannot be bought, it does not matter.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Turning “money solved this” into “money solves everything.”
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing every problem as either solvable with money or hopeless.
- Mental filter: Noticing what money has fixed and overlooking what it could not.
- Magnification: Treating money as far more powerful than it is.

Challenging questions

- What problems have I faced that money could not fix?

- What do I feel when money cannot solve a problem?
- Is there a relationship or need I have tried to solve with money instead of time and presence?
- What does the Bible say about the limits of wealth?
- What would it look like to bring this problem to God and to people, not only to my accounts?
- What is one thing I need that money cannot buy?

Truth summary

> Money is a good tool, but it cannot forgive me, heal my grief, or love me. Some of life's deepest needs are met only by God and by people. I can use my resources wisely and also turn to what money can never provide.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Money
- Riches, Beware of
- Trust
- Worldly
- Thankful

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Money/Riches
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

All Things New — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's renewing work offers hope beyond failure, decay, and loss.

What You Want — Tenth Avenue North
Following God involves trust and surrender without needing control of every outcome.

Turn Your Eyes Upon Jesus — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn directs attention to Christ when fear or earthly concerns dominate.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Money can fix any problem"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Money can fix any problem." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What problem have I tried to solve with money that needs something else?
- ☐ What can money never buy for me?
- ☐ What would presence look like instead of payment?
- ☐ Where do I need to trust God more than my resources?
- ☐ What is enough today?
- ☐ Who needs my time more than my gift?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Money is a tool, not a savior.
- ☐ Some problems need presence, not payment.
- ☐ God provides what money cannot buy.
- ☐ I can use money wisely and trust God.
- ☐ I can be content in many situations.
- ☐ Time and love are worth more than gifts.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Ecclesiastes 5:10
  "He who loves money is never satisfied by money, and he who loves wealth is never satisfied by income. This too is futile."
- ☐ Philippians 4:12–13
  "I know how to live humbly, and I know how to abound. I am accustomed to any and every situation—to being filled and being hungry, to having plenty and having need. I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength."
- ☐ Mark 8:36
  "What does it profit a man to gain the whole world, yet forfeit his soul?"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

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- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
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  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What money could and could not do: Each week, write one problem that money helped and one that it could not touch, and what helped that one.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Ecclesiastes 5:10 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Money is useful, but my deepest needs are met by God and by people.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Riches, Beware of" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

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- [ ] Sort your problems. Make two lists: problems money can help and problems it cannot. Notice what is on the second list.
- [ ] Give time, not only money. Spend an hour with someone this week with no gift attached.
- [ ] Bring one money-proof problem to God. Pray specifically about a problem that cannot be bought off.
- [ ] Practice contentment. Name three things that are enough today.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie “Money can fix any problem”: _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	What money could not buy
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My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Money can fix any problem.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, thank You for what You provide. Keep me from trusting in money to save me. Help me turn to You and to people for what money cannot buy, and teach me to be content in You. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.